

Defending a quantifier-particle approach to Yorùbá exclusives

Ka-Fai Yip & Bode Adedeji

Yale University

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1 Introduction

- Quantification in natural language has (at least) two basic apparatuses:
 - **D-quantification** (e.g., determiner *every*)
 - **A-quantification** (e.g., adverb *always*) (Partee 1991; Chierchia 2021)
 - Exclusive focus particles like *only* are remarkable since they seem to allow for both modes of quantification:
(Horn 1969; Jackendoff 1972; Taglicht 1984; Rooth 1985; Büring and Hartmann 2001; Coppock and Beaver 2014, *i.a.*)
- (1) a. John gave **only**_{adfoc} MARY a book (adfocal only, resembles D-quantification)
- b. John **only**_{adv} gave MARY a book (adverbial only, resembles A-quantification)

- **The debate on exclusive focus particles**
- View ❶: Co-existing D-quantification and A-quantification (Horn 1969; Rooth 1985, 1992; Coppock and Beaver 2014, cf. Yip and Adededeji 2024; Yip 2026 for Yoruba)
 - ➔ Adfocal *only* is a D-quantifier, Adverbial *only* is an A-quantifier (exclusive “operator”)
- View ❷: Reducing D-quantification to A-quantification (Bayer 1996; Lee 2005; Quek and Hirsch 2017; Bassi, Hirsch, and Trinh 2022; Hirsch 2022; Sun 2021; Branan and Erlewine 2023, cf. Aremu 2026 for Yoruba)
 - ➔ Adfocal *only* is a concord particle that signals an exclusive operator

- **Why is the debate important?**
- Reductionist attempts of **other domains** of quantification (Kratzer and Shimoyama 2002; Kratzer 2005; Szabolcsi 2015, 2017, 2018, 2024, cf. Carlson 1983, 2006)
E.g., Negative concord, universal concord, ...
- Semantic universal: All D-quantifiers are **conservative** (Barwise and Cooper 1981)
 - Conservativity: $D(A)(B) = D(A)(A \cap B)$
E.g., *every student came* is true iff every student is a student who came
 - **D-quantifier only is not:** it does not “live on” its restrictor
E.g., *only students came* (not always true) $\neq$ only students are students who came (tautology: always true)

- **Why is Yoruba special?**
- Yoruba has both adverbial (*kàn*) and adfocal (*nìkan*) particles
(vs. languages with only adfocal particles, like Akan, Yip and Ahenkorah 2026; or only adverbial particles, like Cantonese, Yip 2024)
- *kàn* and *nìkan* may be doubled: **exclusive doubling** (reported as early as in Yip 2021)

(2) Adverbial-adfocal exclusive doubling in Yoruba (YO)

- | | | |
|----|---|-------------|
| a. | Ayò kàn fún [Adé] _F ní ìwé | (Adverbial) |
| | Ayo only give Ade SEC book | |
| b. | Ayò fún [Adé] _F nìkan ní ìwé | (Adfocal) |
| | Ayo give Ade only SEC book | |
| c. | Ayò kàn fún [Adé] _F nìkan ní ìwé | (Doubling) |
| | Ayo only give Mary only SEC book | |
| | (a-c): 'Ayo only gave Ade a book.' | |

- **A debate on the proper treatment of the two particles**

- The **quantifier-particle (Q-)** approach: by Yip and Adedeji (2024) and Yip (2026) → supporting View ❶
 $n\grave{a}kan$ is an exclusive D-quantifier, whereas $k\grave{a}n$ is a particle associated with scalarity (non-entailment scale)

$$(3) \quad [\underbrace{[\underbrace{k\grave{a}n}_{[Scalarity]} \dots [\text{XP}_F \underbrace{n\grave{a}kan}_{[Exclusivity]}] \dots }]]$$

$$(4) \quad \llbracket n\grave{a}kan \rrbracket(ALT) = \lambda x_e \lambda P_{\langle e, st \rangle} \lambda w : P(x)(w). \forall y \in ALT [P(y)(w) \rightarrow P(x) \subseteq P(y)]$$

- The **operator-particle (OP-)** approach: by Aremu (2026) → Supporting View ❷

$k\grave{a}n$ is an exclusive A-quantifier (OP), whereas $n\grave{a}kan$ is a particle associated with scalarity (entailment scale)

$$(5) \quad [\underbrace{[\underbrace{k\grave{a}n}_{[Exclusivity]}] \dots [\text{XP}_F \underbrace{n\grave{a}kan}_{[Scalarity]}] \dots }]]$$

$$(6) \quad \llbracket k\grave{a}n \rrbracket(ALT) = \lambda p \lambda w : p(w). \forall q [(q \in ALT \wedge q(w)) \rightarrow p \subseteq q]$$

- Another difference set aside in this talk: covert movement (Q-approach) vs. scalar agreement (OP-approach)

- **Our goals today:**
- We re-examine Aremu 2026's counterarguments. While his observations are interesting and insightful, we show that they **do not challenge** the Q-approach, with:
 - closer empirical scrutiny
 - independent properties of Yoruba considered
- We extend our arguments to two other adfocal particles, *lásán* (Yip and Adedeji 2024) and *péré* (Aremu 2026), and show that they are also D-quantifiers with exclusion performed on different scales.
- ➔ **The Q-approach holds for Yoruba exclusives**, whereas the OP-approach does not.
Implications on quantification and conservativity of quantifiers.
- Data note: Confirmed with 5 additional native speakers (besides the second author), based on Standard Yoruba

2 Defending the Q-approach

- (7) Six arguments in response to Aremu [2026](#)
 - a. Backward association and the lack of reconstruction
 - b. Multiple focus association
 - c. Wide scope under ellipsis
 - d. Problematic assumption of the split scope argument
 - e. Appendix A: Scopal interaction with other operators
 - f. Appendix B: *kàn* is scalar

2.1 Backward association and the lack of reconstruction

- Yip and Adedeji (2024): *kàn*, unlike adverbial *only* in English, allows for backward association with focus (BAwF) of a moved object

(8) # [Mary]_F, John **only** met __ at the party. (Erlewine 2014:11)

Int.: 'Mary is the only person John met at the party.'

(9) German_F (**nìkan**) ni Akín **kàn** şe __. (movement, obj focus)

German only FOC John only do

'It is only *German* that Akin took.'

- BAwF of adverbial 'only' is cross-linguistically banned (e.g., Cantonese, English, Vietnamese, ...; see Erlewine 2014 for a semantic explanation)
 - *kàn* should not be analyzed as an exclusive OP

- Aremu (2026), citing German (Erlewine 2014; Bayer 2018; Hirsch and Wagner 2019, 2025), claims that BA_wF is achieved by reconstruction, so this cannot be evidence against *kàn* as an OP.

(10) Backward association in German

A naturally occurring example from Erlewine (2014, p.189)

Context: I don't deal with this kind of stuff...

das [verwirrt]_F mich **nur** __.

that confuses me only

'That only confuses me.'

← Response: This predicts that BAwF possibilities should **correlate** with quantifier reconstruction possibilities, as Hirsch and Wagner (2019, ex.11-12,36) showed for German.

- **However**: Yorùbá negation **blocks** quantifier reconstruction, but still allows for BAwF.

(11) Reconstruction of universal quantifiers in Yorùbá

a. Akẹ̀kọ̀ọ́ọ́ kan fẹ̀ràn [gbogbo olùkọ́]

student one like every teacher

Narrow ($\exists > \forall$): 'A specific student (e.g., Ade) likes all the teachers' (surface)

Wide ($\forall > \exists$): 'Ade likes the Yorùbá teacher, Bode likes the English teacher, ...' (inverse)

b. [Gbogbo olùkọ́] ni akẹ̀kọ̀ọ́ọ́ kan fẹ̀ràn __

every teacher FOC student one like

Narrow ($\exists > \forall$): 'A specific student (e.g., Ade) likes all the teachers' (reconstructed)

Wide ($\forall > \exists$): 'Ade likes the Yorùbá teacher, Bode likes the English teacher, ...' (surface)

(12) No reconstruction below negation for quantifier scope in Yorùbá

a. Mary kò fẹ̀ràn [gbogbo ènìyàn]

Mary NEG like every person

Narrow: 'Mary only likes some people and dislikes the others.'

$(\neg > \forall)$

Wide: 'Mary is a mean person and likes no one.'

$(\forall > \neg)$

b. [Gbogbo ènìyàn] ni Mary kò fẹ̀ràn __

every person FOC Mary NEG like

NOT Narrow: *'Mary only likes some people and dislikes the others.'

$(*\neg > \forall)$

ONLY Wide: 'Mary is a mean person and likes no one.'

$(\forall > \neg)$

- Not only is BAwF with negation possible, the exclusive scope **cannot** be reconstructed under negation (see also Appendix A)
- Unlike German where BAwF correlates with scope reconstruction of exclusives (Hirsch and Wagner 2019)

(13) Backward association with negation in Yorùbá

a. John kò **kàn** şe German **nìkan**

John NEG only do German only

Narrow: 'It is not only German that John takes (but also French).' (¬>only)

Wide: 'It is only German that John just didn't take.' (i.e., John didn't take German—he took French and Latin) (only>¬)

b. German (**nìkan**) ni John kò **kàn** şe __

German only FOC John NEG only do

ONLY: 'It is only German that John just didn't take.' (i.e., John didn't take German—he took French and Latin) (only>¬)

- Negation blocks scope reconstruction in general and even **bleeds NPI licensing**
- NPI: *N-ki-N* and *N kankan* (e.g., see Ajiboye 2024)

- ➔ Yip and Adededeji (2024)'s argument still holds: *kàn* is not an OP and lacks the lexical association property of adverbial 'only' (Tancredi 1990), and hence exceptionally allowing BAwF
- Challenges the OP approach
 - To our knowledge, the blocking behavior of negation is a **new empirical discovery for Yorùbá**, though it is not uncommon cross-linguistically (e.g., English raising: Boeckx 2001, Mandarin 'again': Xu 2016)

2.2 Wide scope under ellipsis

- Background: English adfocal *only*'s wide scope reading does not survive ellipsis, unlike a QR of a D-quantifier (Bassi, Hirsch, and Trinh 2022, cf. Sag 1976; Fox 2000; Bassi, Hirsch, and Trinh 2022)

- (16) a. Jill may bring **only** WINE. (may>only, only>may)
b. ... Bill may, too. (◇>only, *only>◇)
i# Therefore, Bill cannot bring beer.
ii. ...Of course Bill can also bring beer if he likes.

(adpated from Bassi, Hirsch, and Trinh 2022:816,818)

- (17) a. A boy is standing on **every** building. (...) (every>a)
b. A girl is, too. (every>a)

(Bassi, Hirsch, and Trinh 2022:820)

- One of the strongest arguments for the OP approach
- Drawing on a restriction that A-quantifier *only* cannot associate into ellipsis site (see Han and Romero [2004](#); Beaver and Clark [2008](#); Bassi, Hirsch, and Trinh [2022](#))

- Yip and Adedeji (2024): *nikan*'s wide scope is **retained** after ellipsis (original data confirmed with 4 speakers; confirmed again with the 5 consultants in this study)

(18) Wide scope survives ellipsis in Yorùbá

- a. Olùkọ náà gba John láàyè [láti ẹ German_F *nikan*]. (...)
 teacher the permit John give.chance to do German only
 i. 'The teacher allows John to take only German.' (John can take French if he likes) (permit>only)
 ii. 'The teacher only allows John to take German.' (John cannot take French) (only>permit)
- b. ... Olùkọ gba Mary náà láàyè Δ. (...)
 teacher permit Mary as.well give.chance
 i. 'The teacher also allows Mary to take only German.' (Mary can take French if he likes) (permit>only)
 ii. 'The teacher also only allows Mary to take German.' (Mary cannot take French) (only>permit)

(19) *Wide scope context + continuation*

The school has different language courses: German, French, Yoruba. Mary and John major in German study and must take German. Other languages are not allowed for them due to limited course credits.

(18a+b) ... Fún ìdí èyí Mary kò lè ṣe Faransé.

for reason this Mary NEG can do French

‘(18a+b) ... Therefore, Mary cannot take French.’

→ *nìkan* is a **D-quantifier**, whose wide scope is retained after ellipsis just like QR

- Aremu (2026) claims the opposite: *nìkan*'s wide scope disappears after ellipsis, supporting the OP-approach.
- Yet, he did not replicate our original example reported above, but another example below
- All 5 of our consultants could **not** get the ambiguity even in the non-elided baseline (a) (marked by %).

(20) a. Tolú šèìlérí láti wá [ní òla] *nìkan*.

Tolu promise to come LOC tmr. only

Tolu promised to come only tomorrow.' (prom. > only, %only > prom.)

i. Narrow: 'Tolu made a promist that he would come only tomorrow' (the content of the promise is about coming only tomorrow)

ii. %Wide: 'Only tomorrow is such that Tolu promised to come then.' (tomorrow is the only day for which Dapo made a promist to come, i.e., he made no other promise about another day)

(reported to be available by Aremu 2026, but unavailable for all our consultants)

b. Dàpò nàà šèìlérí [~~VP~~...] pèlú.

Dapo too promise also

i. Narrow: 'Dapo made a promist that he would come only tomorrow.'

ii. *Wide: 'Only tomorrow is such that Dapo promised to come then.' (Aremu 2026:166)

- NB: the narrow scope naturally entails the wide scope, as promising to only come tomorrow means not promising to come on other days.
 - ➔ **Confound:** The truth conditions are hard to tease apart
 - If we turn to cases where the two scopal readings have easily distinguishable truth conditions, wide scope is available even after ellipsis (e.g., (18) above)
- ➔ **The Q-approach holds** but the OP-approach does not, unlike what Aremu 2026 claims

2.3 Multiple focus association

- Yip and Adededeji 2024: *kàn* does not establish its own focus association and must depend on *nìkan*
 - Rationale behind: if *kàn* is really an OP, it should be able to associate with a different focus when the one attached by adfocal particles is outside of *kàn*'s scope

(22) **Only**_{Adfoc} John **only**_{Adv} eats rice.

‘John is the only person who only eats rice (other people eat both rice and noodles)’

(Horn 1969:106, interpretation added)

- We reproduce the argument with clear contexts below:
 - As evidenced by the lack of multiple-‘only’ reading in [Subj-*nìkan*...*kàn*] cases, where the object is not targeted (i.e., bananas are also eaten by Tolu)
 - For both the subject and the object to be targeted, a **second** *nìkan* after the object must be added
- (23) a. [Everyone loves bananas and has eaten some during lunch. Other people don’t like yams and don’t eat them. Tolu just doesn’t want to waste food. So, he just goes ahead and has eaten yam.]
- Tolú *nìkan* ni ó *kàn* jẹ iṣu (#*nìkan*) (subject focus only)
- Tolu only FOC 3SG only eat yam only
- ‘Only *Tolu* ate yam.’
- b. [The quantity of yams is small, so everyone should take little yam and support it with banana so that everyone can get some yam. Stubborn Tolu doesn’t like banana and takes a lot of yam, finishing them. The teacher asks: “Someone took too much yam. Who?”]
- Tolú *nìkan* ni ó *kàn* jẹ iṣu #(*nìkan*) (multi-‘only’ with both subj. and obj. foci)
- Tolu only FOC 3SG only eat yam only
- ‘Only *Tolu* ate only *yam*.’ (other people ate both)

- Aremu (2026): a curious case of the so-called concord reading with two *nìkan*. (cf. Lee 2005 for Korean)
 - Where there is only one exclusive OP associating with both foci (the <Subj, Obj> ordered pair), unexpected if *nìkan* is a D-quantifier (whose multiple occurrence enforces multiple-‘only’ readings)
- **However**, we could **not** replicate his judgment, as well as with our 5 additional consultants: All of them reported **infelicity** in the context below; the only reading is the multiple-‘only’ one (i.e., like (23b))

(24) *There are three people in a room [Adam, John and Sam], and there are three dishes in the room as well [rice, bean, yam]. Q: Who ate what?*

%Ádààmù_F **nìkan** ni ó jẹ ìrẹ̀sì_F **nìkan**

Adam only FOC 3sg eat rice only

‘Nobody ate anything except Adam who ate rice.’ (i.e., The pair <Adam, rice> is the only alternative that satisfies the eating relation)

(reported to be possible by Aremu 2026:167; unavailable for our consultants, marked by %)

- We however noticed that with a stress on the second *NÌKAN* in a different context: → A different multiple ‘only’ reading, where the second *NÌKAN* **associates with the whole clause**.
- The truth condition is similar to what Aremu treated as the “concord” reading, as evidenced by the infelicity of the continuation.
- *nìkan* may associate with a clausal focus, independently (see Yip and Adedeji 2024)

(25) *You’re very angry and regret going to a party. Everyone expected more food, but only rice was served there, and even that, only Adam got rice and you got nothing. Q: What happened in the party?*

a. [Ádààmù_{F1} **nìkan**₁ ni ó jẹ̀ ìrẹ̀sì]_{F2} **NÌKAN**₂

Adam only FOC 3SG eat rice only

‘It’s only that only Adam got rice.’ (nothing happened in the party, other than “only Adam ate rice)

b. #... John jẹ̀ ìrẹ̀sì àti ẹ̀wà, Sam sì jẹ̀ ìrẹ̀sì àti ẹ̀ja dín-dín.

John eat rice and bean Sam and eat rice and fish fried

‘... #John ate rice and bean, and Sam ate rice and fried fish.’

- Importantly, when the second *NÌKAN* is not clause-final, i.e., structurally unambiguous as attaching to the object → The clausal focus reading is gone, only the multiple ‘only’ reading (subj > obj) is available.

(26) a. Ádààmù_{F1} **nìkan**₁ ni ó jẹ̀ [ìrẹ̀sì]_{F2} **NÌKAN**₂ lẹ̀ẹ̀kan

Adam only FOC 3SG eat rice only once

ONLY: ‘Adam is the only person who ate only rice once.’

NOT: ‘It’s only that Adam got only rice once.’

b. ... John jẹ̀ ìrẹ̀sì àti ẹ̀wà, Sam sì jẹ̀ ìrẹ̀sì àti ẹ̀ja dín-dín.

John eat rice and bean Sam and eat rice and fish fried

‘... John ate rice and bean, and Sam ate rice and fried fish.’

- Aremu (2026)’s so-called concord reading indeed involves multiple ‘only’ (clausal focus + subject focus), **supporting the Q-approach** instead of the OP-approach

2.4 Problematic assumption of the split scope argument

- The OP-approach: split scope readings as evidence against QR (Quek and Hirsch 2017; cf. Lee 2005 for Korean)

(27) Split scope readings of English adfocal *only*

You are required to learn **only** *one*_F language.

- a. Non-split: 'There is only a certain language you are required to learn.' (**only** > **one** > require)
 - b. Split: 'You are only required to learn a language, whichever one you choose.' (**only** > require > **one**)
- QR pied-pipes NumP, predicting that its scope should also be tied to the exclusive scope, rather than split scope

(28) The D-quantifier approach with QR

$[_{TP} \text{you } \lambda 1 [_{VP} [\text{only one lang.}] \lambda 3 [_{VP} t_1 \text{ be.required } [_{TP} \text{PRO}_1 \lambda 2 [_{VP} t_2 \text{ learn } t_3]]]]]$

(29) The operator-particle approach

$[_{TP} \text{you}_1 [Op_{EXCL} [_{VP} t_1 \text{ be.required } [_{TP} \text{PRO}_1 \lambda 2 [_{VP} t_2 \text{ learn } [_{FP} F=\text{only}_{adfoc} \text{ one lang.}]]]]]]]$

- Aremu 2026: Yoruba allows split scope readings.
→ Claimed to support the OP-approach over the Q-approach

(30) Split scope readings of Yorùbá adfocal -nìkan

Adam ní láti pa [QP adìẹ [méjì]_F **nìkan**].

Adam has to kill fowl two only

Lit: 'Adam is required to slaughter only two fowls.'

Meaning: Adam is only required to slaughter (any) two fowls (he could slaughter more if he wishes)

(**only** > require > **two**) (adapted from Aremu 2026:200, ex.133)

- This is empirically sound as also confirmed by our consultants
- **However:** Crucial assumption of this argument: NumP = existential quantifier.
- Not necessarily so (Ionin and Matushansky [2006](#); Rothstein [2016](#); Bylinina and Nouwen [2018](#), cf. Link [1987](#), a.m.o.)

- Empirical challenge: split scope readings still available **after overt movement**.
 → Not expected if NumP is existential quantifier, which now should take wide scope

(32) Preservation of split scope readings after movement in Yorùbá

[adìẹ méjì_F **nìkan**] ni Adam ní láti pa ____.

fowl two only FOC Adam has to kill

Lit: 'Adam is required to slaughter only two fowls.'

Meaning: Adam is only required to slaughter (any) two fowls (he could slaughter more if he wishes)

(**only** > require > **two**)

(33) The operator-particle approach: predicts [only > two > require] instead

[Op_{EXCL} [_{FOCP} [_{FP} P_{rt}=*nìkan*_{adfoC} two fowl.] λ3 [_{TP} Adam₁ [_{vP} *t*₁ has.to [_{TP} PRO₁ λ2 [_{vP} *t*₂ kill *t*₃]]]]]]]

- Split scope readings **after movement** also available in other languages where the OP approach is forcefully argued for, based on the expected behavior of adverbial and adfocal particles (e.g., English, Quek and Hirsch [2017](#), and Vietnamese, Yip [2026](#))

- ➔ NumP should denote **properties** rather than an existential quantifier in the above cases.
 - When NumP denote properties, the “split scope readings” can be derived from the Q-approach compositionally (Appendix C)
 - **Takeaway:** The existence of split scope readings is not informative of the debate

3 Varieties of exclusive D-quantifiers

- Yoruba has other exclusive adfocal particles: *Lásán* ‘only, just’ and *péré* ‘only’
- We will show that they are also D-quantifiers, applying the diagnostics we developed for *nìkan*
- Exclusion may be based on different scales, like English quantificational *only* vs. scalar *only*

- (37) a. Mary **only** invited ALEX_F. (Quantificational) (Klinedinst 2004, ex.1)
- b. Bill is **only** a JUNIOR_F/#SENIOR. (Scalar) (Klinedinst 2004, ex.14)

- *Lásán*: allows a rank order reading, similar to the scalar use of English *only* (Yip and Adedeji 2024; Aremu 2026)
- ➔ Exclusion is based on non-entailment scale (rank order)

(38) A rank-order reading with incompatible alternatives

- a. #Ìdà ọgọrin **nìkan** ni John (**kàn**) gbà nínú ẹkọ Faranse.
 present eighty only FOC John only get inside course French
 #‘The only kind of points John got is 80 points for French.’
- b. Ìdà ọgọrin **lásán** ni John (**kàn**) gbà nínú ẹkọ Faranse.
 present eighty just FOC John only get inside course French
 ‘John only got 80 points for French.’ (while Mary got 90 points!)

(Adapted from Yip and Adedeji 2024:ex.5)

- *Péré*: first systematically studied by Aremu (2026)
- We note that it *requires* numerals → Exclusion is based on numerical scale

(39) a. *John **péré** (ni ó) ka [àwọ̀n ìwé Gẹ̀ẹ̀sì]

John only FOC 3SG read PL book English

Int.: 'Only John read English books.'

b. Omo kan **péré** (ni ó) ka [àwọ̀n ìwé Gẹ̀ẹ̀sì]

child one only FOC 3SG read PL book English

'Only one child read English books.'

- *Lásán* and *péré* pass the tests of D-quantifiers

- (40)
- a. **Wide scope under ellipsis** (examples below)
 - b. Lack of scope reconstruction across negation
 - c. Multiple focus association

(41) *Wide scope context: Usually, everyone takes 6 courses in a semester. Ade and Akin are doing QP this semester. The teacher doesn't want them to be distracted, so just 2 is allowed for them.*

a. olùkọ náà gba Ade láàyè [láti ẹ ịẹ méjì **lásán/péré**]

teacher the permit Ade give.chance to do course two only

'The teacher only allows Ade to take two courses.'

b. olùkọ gba Akin náà láàyè Δ

teacher permit Akin as.well give.chance

'The teacher only allows Akin (to take two courses) too.'

c. Fún ìdí èyí Akin kò lè ẹ ịẹ mẹta.

for reason this Akin not can do course three

'Therefore, Akin cannot take three.'

- *Lásán* and *péré* also encode **exclusivity**
- Whose exclusion is based on different scales (cf. Coppock and Beaver 2014 for English)

(42) $\llbracket nikan \rrbracket(ALT) = \lambda x_e \lambda P_{\langle e, st \rangle} \lambda w : P(x)(w). \forall y \in ALT [P(y)(w) \rightarrow \underline{P(x) \subseteq P(y)}]$ (based on entailment)

(43) $\llbracket lásán \rrbracket(ALT) = \lambda x_e \lambda P_{\langle e, st \rangle} \lambda w : P(x)(w). \forall y \in ALT [P(y)(w) \rightarrow \underline{P(x) \geq_s P(y)}]$; s is a non-logical scale

(44) $\llbracket péré \rrbracket(ALT) = \lambda x_e \lambda P_{\langle e, st \rangle} \lambda w : P(x)(w). \forall y \in ALT [P(y)(w) \rightarrow \underline{P(x) \geq_n P(y)}]$; n is a numerical scale

→ A parallelism between A-quantification vs. D-quantification:

(45) **Quantification Entailment scale Rank order Numerical scale**

A-quantifier *exclusively* *just/merely* (Cantonese *sin?* - cf. Yip 2026)

D-quantifier *nikan* *lásán* *péré*

4 Conclusion

- **Summary:**

- Yoruba exclusive adfocal *nìkan* is a D-quantifier; adverbial *kàn* is **not** an exclusive operator
- While Aremu 2026's observations are interesting and insightful, we showed that they do not challenge the Q-approach, especially with independent properties of Yoruba considered (e.g., negation blocks reconstruction)
 - ➔ It is important to consider different aspects of the language before drawing a parallel with superficially similar patterns in other languages
- We extend our arguments to two other adfocal particles, *lásán* (Yip and Adedeji 2024) and *péré* (Aremu 2026), and show that they are also D-quantifiers with exclusion performed on different scales.

(46) D-quantification of exclusives in Yoruba

- a. *Nìkan*: Entailment-based
- b. *Lásán*: Non-logical scale (e.g., rank order)
- c. *Péré*: Numerical scale

- The Q-approach holds for Yoruba exclusives, whereas the OP-approach does not.
- Implication ①: D-quantification **cannot** be reduced to A-quantification (i.e., View ❶)
 - Implication ②: **Not all** D-quantifiers are conservative